

Exercise 1 - Study of the ground state of 2-chlorophenol with different computational methods

ORCA 5.0.2, spin-unrestricted Kohn–Sham, def2-TZVP basis; geometry optimisation followed by an analytic frequency calculation: ! UKS <PBE | B3LYP> def2-TZVP def2/J TightSCF TightOpt Opt Freq, with RIJCOSX for B3LYP and CPCM(Water) for the two solvated runs.

In the supplied structure the hydroxyl hydrogen was perpendicular to the ring. It was rotated into the ring plane on the Cl side (cis conformer, intramolecular O–H···Cl contact) before optimisation; all other atoms were left as given. All four optimised structures have 33 real frequencies and no imaginary mode, i.e. they are minima. The other conformer, with the O–H pointing away from Cl, was optimised as a check at the same level (B3LYP/def2-TZVP, gas phase): it is also a minimum but lies 3.3 kcal mol⁻¹ higher in energy (3.0 kcal mol⁻¹ in Gibbs free energy at 298.15 K), which is the intramolecular O–H···Cl interaction. The cis conformer used here is therefore the relevant ground-state structure.

a) Mulliken and Löwdin atomic charges

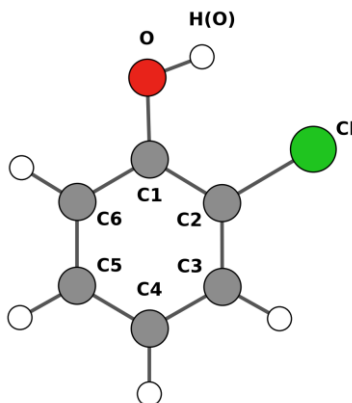


Figure 1. Atom numbering used in Table 1. H(Cn) is the hydrogen bonded to Cn; H(O) is the hydroxyl hydrogen.

Table 1. Atomic charges (e), UKS/def2-TZVP.

Atom	Mulliken				Löwdin			
	PBE gas	B3LYP gas	PBE water	B3LYP water	PBE gas	B3LYP gas	PBE water	B3LYP water
Cl	-0.1320	-0.1390	-0.1302	-0.1399	+0.3901	+0.3753	+0.3877	+0.3711
O	-0.3215	-0.3783	-0.3568	-0.4165	+0.1091	+0.0948	+0.0963	+0.0801
C1	+0.1421	+0.1795	+0.1598	+0.1996	-0.2951	-0.2832	-0.3003	-0.2879
C2	+0.1463	+0.1281	+0.1257	+0.1112	-0.4167	-0.4058	-0.4220	-0.4099
C3	-0.1728	-0.1632	-0.1961	-0.1845	-0.1488	-0.1433	-0.1512	-0.1448
C4	-0.1165	-0.1230	-0.1557	-0.1601	-0.1545	-0.1510	-0.1589	-0.1541
C5	-0.0866	-0.0898	-0.1254	-0.1268	-0.1413	-0.1351	-0.1459	-0.1383
C6	-0.1931	-0.1878	-0.2251	-0.2186	-0.1181	-0.1136	-0.1258	-0.1210
H(O)	+0.2975	+0.3078	+0.3358	+0.3452	+0.1768	+0.1750	+0.1919	+0.1894
H(C3)	+0.1173	+0.1245	+0.1495	+0.1549	+0.1507	+0.1478	+0.1587	+0.1554
H(C4)	+0.1052	+0.1110	+0.1415	+0.1459	+0.1467	+0.1436	+0.1546	+0.1513
H(C5)	+0.1051	+0.1125	+0.1410	+0.1471	+0.1478	+0.1450	+0.1558	+0.1528
H(C6)	+0.1090	+0.1177	+0.1359	+0.1424	+0.1533	+0.1506	+0.1592	+0.1559

Water increases the charge separation in the hydroxyl group. The Mulliken charge on O goes from -0.322 to -0.357 (PBE) and from -0.378 to -0.417 (B3LYP), and the hydroxyl H goes from $+0.297$ to $+0.336$ and from $+0.308$ to $+0.345$. B3LYP puts more negative charge on O than PBE. The two partitioning schemes disagree most for the heteroatoms: Löwdin gives Cl a positive charge ($+0.37$ to $+0.39$) and O a small positive one, where Mulliken gives negative values. Atomic charges are not observables, and the two schemes divide the overlap density differently, so only the trends within one scheme should be compared.

b) Vibrational frequencies

Table 2. Harmonic vibrational frequencies (cm^{-1}), ORCA mode numbering (modes 0–5 are translations and rotations).

Mode	PBE gas	B3LYP gas	PBE water	B3LYP water
6	154.5	159.5	155.2	159.6
7	245.2	253.0	240.3	247.7
8	255.5	264.9	255.1	264.2
9	365.9	376.2	366.4	376.3
10	429.6	435.1	429.2	388.8
11	475.4	454.7	439.3	453.0
12	484.4	496.2	483.0	494.8
13	532.9	551.9	536.3	554.9
14	546.3	565.4	545.7	564.5
15	669.9	687.6	665.3	682.8
16	688.5	718.0	696.7	725.9
17	727.1	760.9	728.7	761.7
18	824.1	846.4	820.2	842.0
19	824.4	865.9	827.6	868.4
20	887.6	939.2	904.4	954.2
21	907.7	957.8	929.8	979.9
22	1020.9	1047.3	1016.0	1042.6
23	1033.5	1064.9	1031.1	1061.8
24	1111.8	1142.8	1104.3	1135.8
25	1143.2	1181.4	1132.2	1172.0
26	1185.4	1214.2	1170.2	1197.8
27	1248.8	1278.6	1233.4	1264.6
28	1303.6	1325.1	1298.1	1318.7
29	1364.6	1372.7	1355.7	1363.2
30	1451.2	1495.3	1444.5	1488.7
31	1468.4	1514.1	1458.4	1504.8
32	1583.5	1625.6	1576.7	1619.2
33	1593.0	1634.5	1583.2	1625.3
34	3109.7	3175.6	3110.2	3176.9
35	3121.9	3188.2	3120.0	3186.9
36	3128.9	3195.9	3126.4	3193.7
37	3137.0	3203.1	3135.5	3202.3
38	3567.0	3721.7	3561.5	3704.6

B3LYP gives higher frequencies than PBE for nearly every mode (on average by 2.8 % in the gas phase). The largest difference is the O–H stretch (mode 38): 3567 cm^{-1} with PBE and 3722 cm^{-1} with B3LYP. Water shifts most modes by only a few cm^{-1} ; the O–H stretch is lowered by 6 cm^{-1} (PBE) and 17 cm^{-1} (B3LYP).

c)–e) Electric dipole moment, entropy at room temperature and HOMO–LUMO gap

Table 3. Dipole moment, entropy at 298.15 K and frontier orbital energies. $S_{el} = 0$ (closed-shell singlet); ORCA treats the low-frequency vibrations with Grimme's quasi-RRHO model. HOMO = orbital 32, LUMO = orbital 33 (α and β identical).

Quantity	PBE gas	B3LYP gas	PBE water	B3LYP water
Dipole moment μ (D)	0.751	0.880	0.896	1.091
S_{vib} (cal mol ⁻¹ K ⁻¹)	12.62	12.10	12.75	12.30
S_{rot} (cal mol ⁻¹ K ⁻¹)	28.64	28.63	28.65	28.63
S_{trans} (cal mol ⁻¹ K ⁻¹)	40.47	40.47	40.47	40.47
S total (cal mol ⁻¹ K ⁻¹)	81.73	81.19	81.86	81.40
T-S (kcal mol ⁻¹)	24.37	24.21	24.41	24.27
E_{HOMO} (eV)	-5.676	-6.449	-5.666	-6.429
E_{LUMO} (eV)	-1.490	-0.690	-1.463	-0.647
HOMO–LUMO gap (eV)	4.186	5.759	4.204	5.782

The dipole moment grows from PBE to B3LYP and from gas to water (0.75 D for PBE in the gas phase, 1.09 D for B3LYP in water): the continuum polarises the molecule. The entropy is almost method-independent (81.2–81.9 cal mol⁻¹ K⁻¹); the translational and rotational parts depend only on mass and geometry, and only the vibrational part changes a little through the low-frequency modes. The HOMO–LUMO gap is 1.6 eV larger with the hybrid functional (5.76 vs 4.19 eV in the gas phase), while water changes it by only 0.02 eV (PBE) and 0.02 eV (B3LYP).

Normal mode 12

“Normal mode number 12” is ambiguous, because the two common numbering schemes differ. ORCA numbers all 3N modes from 0, so modes 0–5 are the translations and rotations and mode 12 is the seventh vibration. Avogadro and Chemcraft list only the 33 real vibrations, starting at 1, so their twelfth entry is ORCA's mode 17. Both are given here.

Table 4. The two modes that “mode 12” can refer to, B3LYP/def2-TZVP gas phase.

	ORCA mode 12	ORCA mode 17
Position in the list	12th of all modes (7th vibration)	17th of all modes (12th vibration)
Frequency (cm ⁻¹)	496.2	760.9
IR intensity (km mol ⁻¹)	11.2	69.4
PBE gas / B3LYP gas / PBE water / B3LYP water (cm ⁻¹)	484.4 / 496.2 / 483.0 / 494.8	727.1 / 760.9 / 728.7 / 761.7

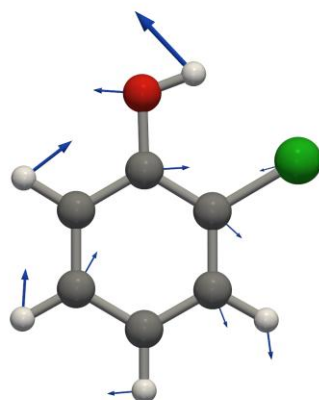


Figure 2. ORCA mode 12 (the 7th vibration), 496.2 cm^{-1} , IR intensity 11.2 km mol^{-1} : in-plane deformation of the ring coupled to C–O–H bending, with the hydroxyl hydrogen moving most. Arrows: atomic displacements. Animation: [ex1_mode12_animation_B3LYP_gas.gif](#).

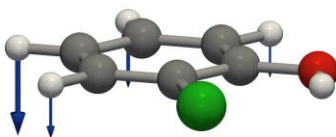
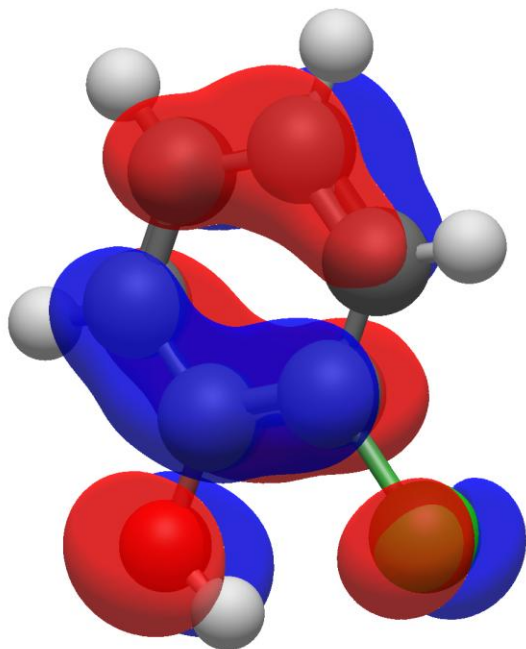


Figure 3. ORCA mode 17, i.e. the 12th vibration as listed by Avogadro, 760.9 cm^{-1} , IR intensity 69.4 km mol^{-1} : out-of-plane bending of the ring C–H bonds. Animation: [ex1_mode17_animation_B3LYP_gas.gif](#).

HOMO and LUMO (B3LYP/def2-TZVP, gas phase)

HOMO



LUMO

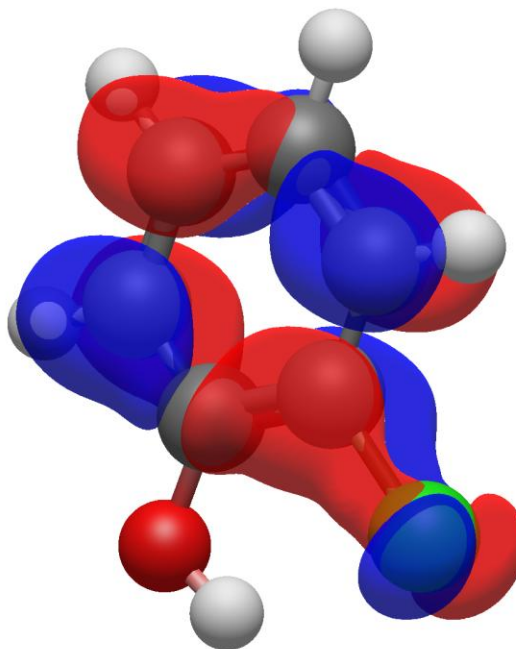


Figure 4. HOMO (orbital 32, -6.45 eV) and LUMO (orbital 33, -0.69 eV), isovalue ± 0.02 a.u.; the two colours are the two phases of the orbital. Plotted with Avogadro 2 directly from the ORCA wavefunction (Molden file); Avogadro numbers the same orbitals 33 and 34, because it counts from 1 and ORCA from 0.

Both frontier orbitals are π orbitals. The HOMO is a ring π orbital with one nodal plane across the ring and antibonding contributions from the p lone pairs of O and Cl. The LUMO is a ring π^* orbital with a small Cl contribution and almost none on O. The HOMO $\rightarrow$ LUMO excitation is the main component of the lowest excited state in Exercise 4.

Electron density and electrostatic potential (B3LYP/def2-TZVP, gas phase)

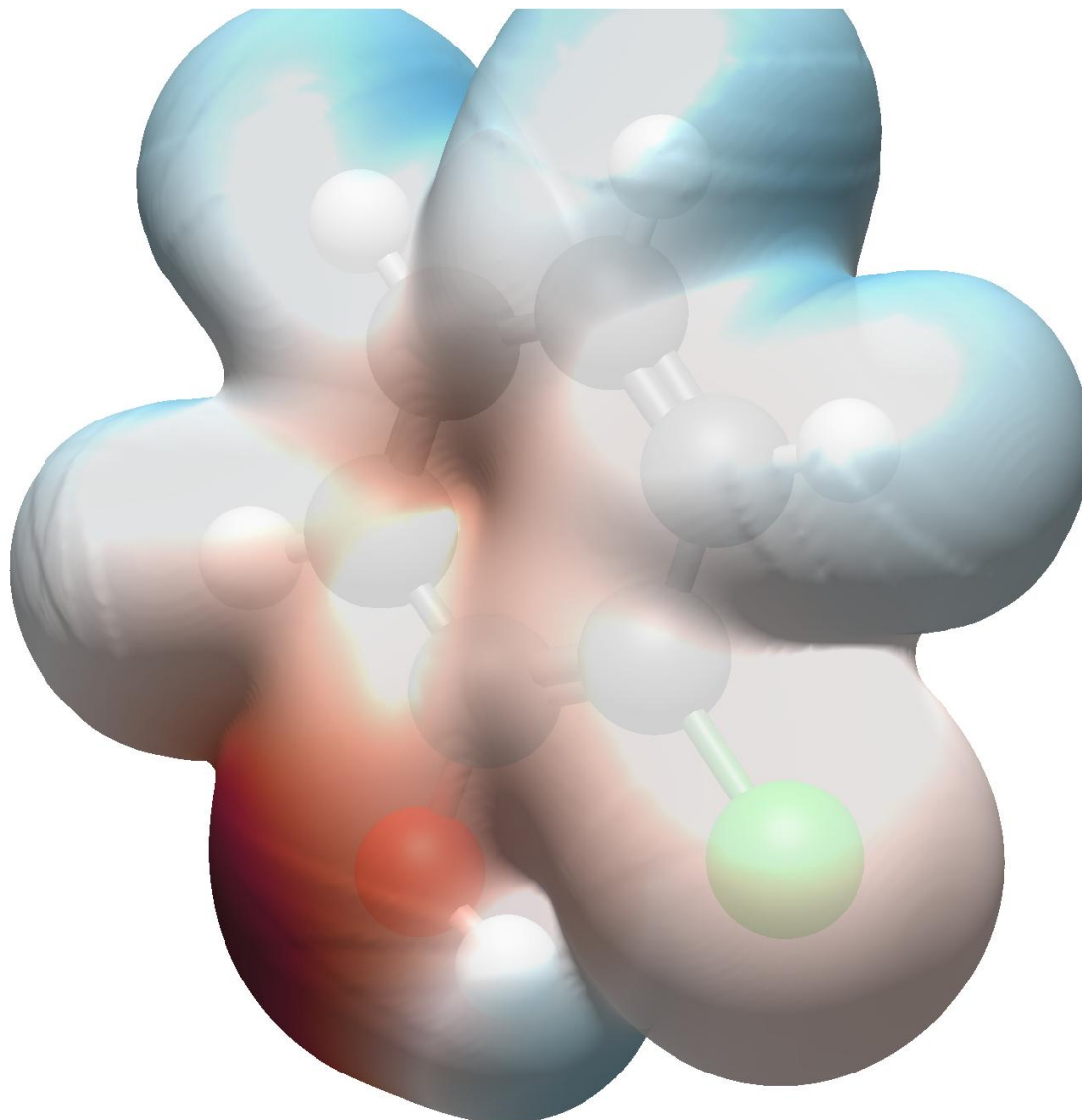


Figure 5. Electron density isosurface (0.001 a.u.) coloured by the electrostatic potential: red = negative, blue = positive. Plotted with Avogadro 2 from the ORCA wavefunction (Molden file). The isosurface itself is the true B3LYP density; the colours are the potential of Avogadro's built-in point-charge model (EEM), which is the only electrostatic potential Avogadro offers.

On the 0.001 a.u. density surface the potential computed from the wavefunction itself (ORCA `orca_vpot`) ranges from -0.035 to $+0.061$ a.u. The most negative region is the oxygen lone pair on the side away from Cl, and the π face of the ring is also negative. The most positive region is the hydroxyl hydrogen, which points towards Cl (intramolecular O-H $\cdots$ Cl contact); the ring hydrogens are moderately positive.

Note on the figure: Avogadro places point charges on the nuclei and evaluates their potential on the surface. This reproduces the negative region at oxygen and the positive hydrogens, but it cannot reproduce the negative potential above and below the aromatic ring, because that comes from the π

electron distribution and not from any set of atom-centred charges. The numbers quoted above are therefore taken from `orca_vpot`, which evaluates the potential from the wavefunction.